Interview tip: Explain impact

Recently, you learned that it can be useful to share the beneficial effects of any process, concept, or tool you discuss. Whether it's applying a concept to identify a potential problem or discussing a tool's utility, explaining the potential impact will help you stand out to an interviewer. In this reading, you'll review the best practices you learned from the interview and why it will be useful for your own future interviews. You'll also explore some examples of questions that interviewers might ask you so that you can practice your answers. Afterwards, you can use Interview Warmup to practice this new tip!

Explain impact

Explaining how you have the skills necessary to fulfill a job role's responsibilities is an important part of the job application process. But it's just as important to understand and demonstrate the positive impact your skills can have for an organization. It is crucial to share examples that illustrate your skills. When doing so, you should also explain why each example is important and relevant to the organization's interests. For example, if you're discussing a project you worked on previously, explain what the benefits of that project were. If you're explaining your skills using a certain tool, tie that to why being able to use that tool would be impactful for future projects.

Build interview skills

You know how to demonstrate your problem solving skills by discussing your thought process and showcase your skills by providing examples. Now you have another tip to add to your interview skills: explain impact. Reviewing tips from other professionals who have gone through the interview process and practicing what you learned are great ways to develop those skills more and more over time.

Practice interview skills

With this new tip to add to your interview toolkit, you'll want to practice answering questions you could encounter in an actual interview. Here is a list of questions you might apply this tip during in an interview:

- Discuss a time when you had to derive data from a raw data set that you received—describe your process and any challenges that you've experienced.
- What considerations would you think about to make sure users got the most out of their data?
- What is an example of a time when your work was key to a project's success?